

ZIB

Stars: Red

Known for: Zib's Astrolab, Hamsa-Yurbul Trading Post, The Magnetar

Exports: Noble gases, ores

Imports: Food and water

Zib is one of the smaller systems in the horizon. With only four planets orbiting a red star, it spans just over 30 AU. The only truly inhabited world is Zib, in whose orbit lies the Hamsa-Yurbul space station.

Zib's daughter system, which was only discovered in 475 PW and explored in 480 PW by the crew of the Zarathustra, is interesting. The sun of the system is a magnetar that devoured the actual sun long ago. The fact that it is a magnetar makes sensor detection extremely difficult, and so the system remained undiscovered for a long time despite its proximity to the Zib system.

ZIB SYSTEM

The planet Zib has several large settlements, but is still far from being an established colony. The largest of these settlements is Gahatea, which also boasts the planet's most advanced research facility, the Astrolab. While the rest of the population has to make do with relative poverty and primitive technology, the inhabitants of Gahatea enjoy a stable network of information channels and advanced infrastructure.

The Astronomical Institute in the colony on Zib is a place often used to train astronomers across the horizon. Although the Astrolab does not provide the most advanced technology, it offers the most affordable prices for training. Otherwise, the laboratory's main function is to map the stellar constellations in this area of the horizon and identify traces of other habitable systems. Of particular interest is a nearby newly formed star that may be reachable with the new jump drive technology.

In orbit around Zib is a small and already outdated space station run by the brothers Hamsa and Yurbul. Both are always on the station and personally welcome arriving travellers with a video transmission, even honouring many with an unsolicited visit to 'deepen business relations.' The meals are, of course, at the expense of the hosts, who are always the arriving ships.

OVERVIEW ZIB

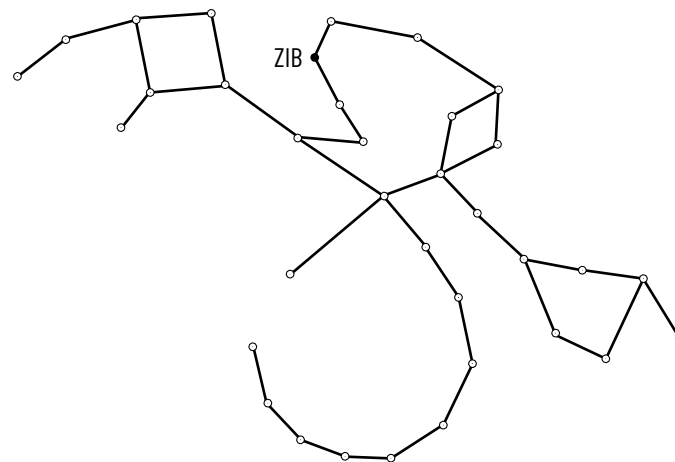
Zib: Cold tundra world, home of the Hamsa-Yurbul trading post and the famous Astrolab.

Z II: Dead rock with no atmosphere.

Asteroid Belt: Small asteroid belt with minor resources.

Z III: Rich gas giant with some mining facilities.

Meogawa: Small colony of ore miners.



PORTALS TO
TARAZUG AND MIRA
0,5 AU

ZIB AND
TRADING POST
3 AU

Z II
9 AU

ASTEROID BELT
25 AU

Z III
28 AU

MEOWAWA
31 AU

ZIB



MOTH'S SONG
6 AU



VARIYAN
9 AU



REY
13 AU



MAGNETAR SYSTEM

The system can be reached a good 85 AU after Meogawa, at which point one enters the outer edge of the magnetar's sphere of influence. As soon as one enters the system (from 24 AU from the star), one falls under strong magnetic currents that increasingly interfere with communication and sensors. The magnetar's gravitational pull also affects the flight speed based on the mass of the individual ships. A ship can easily reach more than twice its normal maximum cruising speed in the inner magnetosphere. However, escaping from the magnetar takes all the longer.

The Magnetar system comprises a total of three planets, the innermost of which, called Moth's Song, cannot be reached or left using current propulsion systems, and therefore no data is available about it. For the other two planets, the crew of the Zarathustra provided superficial sensor results to the Astronomical Institute on Zib.

OVERVIEW MAGNETAR

Moth's Song: Can neither be reached or left and is thus unknown.

Variyan: An extremely large world without atmosphere. Only reachable by small ships with extremely strong m-drive.

Rey: Belongs to the category of dwarf planets. Its surface consists mainly of normal rock and dust, and it has no atmosphere, but the planet is far enough away from the magnetar to be safely visited.